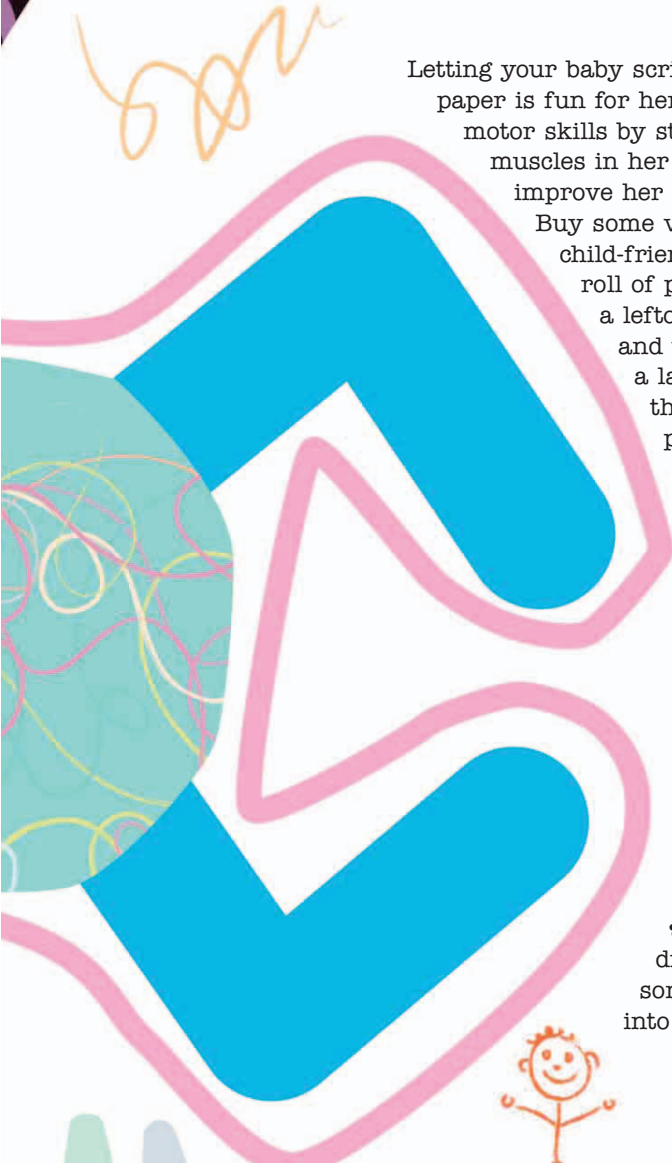




Letting your baby scribble and make marks on paper is fun for her and improves her fine motor skills by strengthening the smaller muscles in her fingers. It also helps improve her hand-eye coordination.

Buy some very chunky, nontoxic, child-friendly crayons and a cheap roll of plain paper—or recycle a leftover roll of wallpaper and use the plain side. Cover a large area of the floor with the paper and tape the paper down at the edges.

- ✿ Sit on the floor with your baby and guide her hand (if she wants your help) to make different marks on the paper.

- ✿ Lie her down on the paper, draw an outline around her, and let her scribble inside to fill in the silhouette.

- ✿ Draw simple shapes and patterns and name them all for her.

- ✿ At the end of your drawing session, cut out some of her art and stick it into a scrapbook.

